

few kinds of images where the dark pixels do not tend toward blackness. Otherwise, the image tends to look weird.

- **Colour Enhance:** Enhancing the colour in an image does a lot to change how significant portions of the image look. This function is used to control the saturation of the image without any changes to the brightness or hue. Therefore this function has no visible effect on grayscale images.
- **Stretch Contrast:** This is an alternative to the above mentioned Normalize plugin. The only difference is that it works on the RGB (Red, Green and Blue) channels of an image independently. It is mostly used to remove color casts.
- **Stretch HSV:** It is an alternative to Stretch Contrast that works with the HSV values instead of RGB
- **White Balance:** Often seen in grayscale images and images with higher brightness, this plugin is used to remove excess whites in a scope. It is often used to remove large areas of white and relatively white or dark and relatively dark pixels to improve the overall color and stretch across the image range.
- **Auto Levels:** The auto tools can be found at Tools > Colour Tools > Levels or at Colour > Levels. It is an automated process of improving the colour of an image though inbuilt algorithmic calculations based on the required levels of saturation. If you can find a section in the image that should be perfectly black and another section of the image that can be perfectly white, then you can use the semi auto level correction that can often yield better output in terms of overall brightness and colours of the image.

Conclusion

Capturing and editing photos to create an impression has been in practice since the old Kodak days. With the advent of powerful computing systems and applications that help us modify each and every pixel in an image, photo editing has come way beyond its traditional roots. It has now evolved into a profession of its own works in conjunction with numerous other fields like video and sound editing to create effects previously unseen to humans. It is still evolving and therefore learning the skills is as important today as it was a decade back. 